**QP CODE: 24900033**

**MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM**

**FIRST SEM MGU-UGP(HONOURS) REGULAR**

**EXAMINATION NOVEMBER 2024**

**First Semester**

**Multi-Disciplinary Course - MG1MDCBOT100, MG1MDCCBBT100 - ECOTOURISM**

**(2024 Admission Onwards)**

Duration: 1 hours Max Marks: 35

Remember (K), Understand (U), Apply (A), Analyse (An), Evaluate (E), Create (C), Interest (I), Appreciation (Ap), and Skill (S)

*Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability*

**Part A.**

Short Answers
Answer any five questions.
Each question carries 1 mark.

1. **Define ecotourism.**
   Ecotourism is responsible travel to natural areas that conserves the environment, sustains the well-being of the local people, and involves interpretation and education. **(Any related definition)**

2. **What is meant by visitor management at an ecotourism site?**
   It is part of ecotourism planning involving sustainable entry and management of tourist to the ecotourism site without adversely affecting the natural essence of the site **(Any related definition).**

3. **List the stakeholders in ecotourism.**
   Local communities, Tourists, suppliers, local governments, business owners, tourism agencies, NGO etc. **(Any one)**

4. **What are national parks?**
   A national park is a protected area set aside by a national government for the preservation of the natural environment. It is an in-situ conservation. **(Marks can be given for examples)**

5. **What are biodiversity Hotspots?**
   Biodiversity hotspots are regions that contain a high level of species diversity

**(Marks can be given for examples)**

6. **Expand WWF.**
   World Wide Fund for Nature/ World Wildlife Fund

7. **List two geographical features important for ecotourism.**
   Landscape, hills, mountains, water bodies etc. **(Any 2)**

8. **Which ecofriendly hill station in Kerala is known for its tea plantations and natural beauty.**
   Munnar, Vagamon **(or any such hill stations of Kerala)**

**5x1……..5 marks**

## Part B.

Short Essay Type Questions
Answer any four questions.
Each question carries 5 marks

9. **What makes Kerala a popular destination for ecotourism?**
   - Geographical location of Kerala in Indian subcontinent.
   - Holds the rich biodiversity and beauty of western ghats.
   - The western ghats are inland, and the slopes of the mountains are home to the tea, coffee, spices and fauna plantations.
   - The beaches and backwaters of it are known for their palm-line network of canals.
   - Presence of natural heritage sites.
   - Unique cultural, festivals and continental dishes. **(Any 5 relevant points)**

10. **Discuss the economic and social benefits of ecotourism**
    Economic benefits
    - Employment opportunities to local communities.
    - Revenue to government.
    - Benefits business opportunities in tourism.
    - Economic growth in basic infrastructure.
    - Diversify local income source
    - Benefits artisans selling local crafts or handicrafts etc.

    Social benefits

    - Lifestyle improvement of local communities.
    - Community development and enrichment.
    - Social inclusion among the communities.
    - Encourage respect and appreciation of different culture and traditions.

    **(Any 5 relevant points)**

**11. What are natural resources and why are they important for attracting visitors?**

- Natural resources in ecotourism are the components found in the natural environment
- Natural resources in ecotourism includes biodiversity, flora, fauna, natural environment, natural ecosystem, natural landscapes, forest, grassland, woodlands, hills and mountains, plateaus, deserts and valleys, islands and beaches, seas and oceans, rivers and lakes etc.
- These resources give esthetic appeal, outdoor adventure and recreational opportunities. (A**ny 5 relevant points)**

**12. Why is it important to conduct environmental impact assessment in ecotourism?**

- Conducting an Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA) in ecotourism is critical for ensuring that tourism activities do not harm the environment, biodiversity, or local communities.
- It is critical for carrying out sustainable practices of ecotourism.
- Helps in protecting ecosystems and biodiversity.
- Helps in mitigating environmental degradation. Ensuring Social and Economic Benefits for local communities. **(Any related 5 points)**

**13. Discuss the role of TIES in promoting ecotourism.**

- Establishing and Promoting Ecotourism Standards.
- Policy Advocacy and Awareness Raising.
- Education and Training via certified courses.
- Support for Local Communities and Indigenous Peoples.
- Networking and Collaboration within the tourism industry.
- Promoting Conservation and Sustainable Practices.
- Influence on Global Ecotourism Trends. (**Any 5 relevant points**)

**14. Briefly describe the steps involved in ecotourism planning.**

Ecotourism planning involves following steps:

- Preliminary assessment
- Stake holder engagement
- Determining goals and objectives
- Carrying capacity
- Infrastructure
- Visitors' management
- Conservation of ecosystem in the area
- Community involvement and benefits. (**Any 5 relevant points)**

**4x5……..20 marks**

## Part C.

Essay Type Questions
Answer any one question.

Question carries 10 marks

15. **Discuss the importance of cultural resources, natural heritage sites, festivals, and local events in ecotourism. How do local traditions, customs and festivals enhance the visitor experience?**

**(Very liberal valuation, examples can be considered)**

- Cultural resources, not only enhance the appeal of ecotourism destinations but also contribute to the preservation of local cultures, traditions, and natural environments.

- These elements provide visitors with deeper, more authentic connections to the destinations they visit, while simultaneously supporting conservation, cultural preservation, and economic development in local communities.

- When managed responsibly, they also help diversify the tourism product, increase the attractiveness of destinations, and ensure that ecotourism delivers lasting benefits to both visitors and host communities.

- Definition and description of ecotourism resources like cultural, natural heritage sites, festivals, and local events. ……..**8 marks**

- Local traditions, customs, and festivals play a significant role in enhancing the visitor experience in ecotourism and travel in general.

- These cultural elements provide tourists with a deeper understanding of the destination, making their journey more memorable, meaningful, and enriching…….……..**2 marks**

16. **Analyze the functioning of various ecotourism centers in Kerala, assessing their operational models, successes and areas for improvement.**

**(Liberal valuation)**

- Description on location, activity, management, biodiversity, challenges of any two ecotourism centers in Kerala.

Example:

- Thenmala ecotourism (Kollam)
- Periyar wildlife sanctuary ( Thekkady)
- Munnar, Gavi, Chinnar, Kakkayam, KoNni, Thattekkad etc.

**1x10……..10 marks**